Chapter 1 — Education

IELTS Writing Band 7 — 6-Week Master Preparation System

Study material for guided and independent practice.
Read actively — this is training material, not a text to memorize.

Chapter 1 — Education

Part A — Topic Map

Education is one of the most frequently tested IELTS Writing themes. Before studying the full material below, look over the ten directions examiners commonly test. Later chapters and practice sheets will develop each of these further.

Sub-topic	Typical angle examiners test
Free education	Public funding vs private/paid education; access vs quality; who should pay
Online vs traditional education	Flexibility vs face-to-face interaction; access vs quality; blended solutions
Exams vs continuous assessment	Fairness, stress, and accuracy of measuring real ability
Teachers vs parents	Who shapes children's values, discipline, and achievement
University education	Cost vs benefit; free vs paid; relevance to employment
Vocational training	Status compared with academic degrees; employability; investment
Technology in education	Engagement vs distraction; equal access; the digital divide
Homework	Value for learning vs pressure on children; alternatives
Practical vs academic skills	Curriculum balance; workplace preparation; personal growth
Children's development	Role of school vs family vs technology; early-years education

The pilot topic developed in full detail below is **Online vs Traditional Education**. It demonstrates the complete study method; the other nine sub-topics will be produced using the same template in later practice sheets.

Part B — Reading Passage: Online Learning versus Traditional Classroom Education

In the past two decades, advances in digital technology have made online learning increasingly **accessible** to students worldwide, raising an important question: can virtual classrooms genuinely replace traditional, face-to-face instruction? While both approaches offer distinct advantages, a closer examination of their respective strengths and weaknesses suggests that the most effective educational systems are likely to combine elements of each.

One of the strongest arguments in favour of online learning is the **flexibility** it offers to learners who cannot attend fixed classes. Working adults, parents, and students living in remote areas often find it difficult to study at a specific location and time; an online course, however, can be accessed at whatever hour suits the learner, since lessons are frequently **tailored** to allow self-paced progress. This flexibility also helps **widen access** to education for people who would otherwise be excluded by geography or cost, as digital resources tend to be considerably cheaper to deliver than maintaining a physical campus.

Nevertheless, online education is not without serious drawbacks. Perhaps the most frequently cited concern is the lack of **face-to-face interaction** between students and teachers. Although video calls and discussion forums can partly compensate, they rarely replicate the immediacy of a live classroom, where a teacher can notice confusion on a student's face and adjust the lesson accordingly. Furthermore, remote study demands a high degree of **self-discipline**; without the structure of fixed timetables and the presence of classmates, many learners procrastinate or lose motivation altogether. **Technical difficulties**, such as poor internet connectivity or unfamiliarity with digital platforms, can also disrupt learning, particularly in developing regions where infrastructure is inconsistent.

Traditional classroom education, by contrast, provides an inherently **interactive** learning environment. Students benefit not only from direct guidance but also from opportunities for **socialization**, group work, and extracurricular activities that contribute to their broader personal development. In subjects such as science,

engineering, or medicine, **hands-on experience** in laboratories and workshops is difficult, if not impossible, to replace with a screen. Consequently, many educators argue that practical disciplines will always require some element of physical attendance, regardless of how advanced online tools become.

Given these competing advantages, the most sensible solution for most institutions is a blended model that combines online flexibility with classroom interaction. Universities, for example, might deliver theoretical content through recorded lectures while reserving in-person sessions for discussion, laboratory work, and assessment. Such an approach can reduce educational inequality by reaching students who cannot otherwise attend university, while still preserving the social and practical benefits of traditional teaching.

In conclusion, neither online nor traditional education is inherently superior; each addresses different needs and faces different limitations. Although online learning considerably improves accessibility and flexibility, it cannot fully substitute the interactive, hands-on, and socially rich experience offered by physical classrooms. A carefully designed blend of the two, supported by sound policy and sufficient investment, offers the most promising path towards an education system that is both effective and inclusive.

Part C — 10 High-Value Vocabulary Items

Word / Phrase	Simple Meaning	Useful Collocation	IELTS-Style Example
accessible	easy to reach, use, or obtain	make something accessible to	Public libraries make books accessible to people who cannot afford to buy them.
flexibility	ability to adapt to changing needs	offer greater flexibility	Remote work offers employees greater flexibility in managing their daily schedules.
face-to-face interaction	direct, in-person communication	lack of face-to-face interaction	Critics argue that excessive screen time reduces face-to-face interaction among young children.
self-discipline	controlling one's own behaviour without supervision	require a high degree of self-discipline	Working from home requires a high degree of self-discipline to remain productive.
interactive	involving active participation	an interactive learning environment	Modern classrooms increasingly rely on interactive whiteboards to engage students.
socialization	learning to interact appropriately with others	opportunities for socialization	Team sports provide children with valuable opportunities for socialization.

tailored	designed to suit particular needs	tailored to individual needs	Private tutoring can be tailored to individual needs far more precisely than large classes.
widen access	make something available to more people	widen access to higher education	Scholarship programs aim to widen access to higher education for low-income students.
technical difficulties	problems related to equipment or technology	experience technical difficulties	Several students experienced technical difficulties during the online examination.
hands-on experience	practical, direct involvement in an activity	gain hands-on experience	Internships allow graduates to gain hands-on experience before entering the job market.

Part D — Collocation Bank

- reduce educational inequality
- widen the gap between rich and poor students
- bridge the digital divide
- foster independent learning
- undermine academic performance
- invest in digital infrastructure
- strike a balance between flexibility and structure

Part E — Idea Bank

Formula: **Idea → Why → How → Result → Example**

POSITIVE **Online learning increases access to education for people who cannot attend a physical institution.**

Why? Many potential students live far from universities, work full-time, or have family responsibilities.

How? Online platforms let them study recorded lectures and complete assignments at any time that suits them.

Result? More people from disadvantaged backgrounds can obtain qualifications they would otherwise be denied.

Example? A single parent in a rural area can complete a degree part-time at night after their children are asleep.

NEGATIVE **Online learning can weaken students' social and communication skills.**

Why? Students rarely meet classmates or teachers in person.

How? Interaction is limited to text messages, forums, and occasional video calls.

Result? Students may struggle with teamwork and reading social cues in real workplaces.

Example? A graduate who studied entirely online may feel uncomfortable presenting ideas in a face-to-face business meeting.

INDIVIDUAL **Learners must take responsibility for managing their own time in flexible study systems.**

Why? Without fixed class schedules, there is no external pressure to attend sessions.

How? Students need to set personal deadlines, create study routines, and limit distractions.

Result? Those with strong self-discipline succeed, while others often fall behind or drop out.

Example? Many online course providers report that only a small percentage of enrolled students complete free courses without structured deadlines.

GOVERNMENT **Governments can reduce the disadvantages of online learning by investing in digital infrastructure.**

Why? Many students, especially in developing regions, lack reliable internet access or suitable devices.

How? Public funding can subsidise broadband expansion and provide devices to low-income families.

Result? Inequality between urban and rural students is reduced, allowing more learners to benefit equally.

Example? Some governments distributed free tablets and mobile data to students during school closures to keep lessons accessible.

SOLUTION **Combining online and traditional methods produces a more effective overall education system.**

Why? Each method compensates for weaknesses in the other.

How? Institutions deliver theoretical content online while reserving classroom time for discussion and practical work.

Result? Students gain flexibility without losing the interactive and hands-on elements of traditional teaching.

Example? Many universities now offer "blended" degree programs where lectures are online but laboratory sessions remain on campus.

Part F — Reusable Sentence Patterns

1. Pattern: "One of the main advantages/disadvantages of X is that..." — *Function:* introduce a key point.
Example: One of the main disadvantages of relying solely on exams is that it rewards memorization rather than genuine understanding.

2. Pattern: "Although X can provide several benefits, it may also..." — *Function:* concede a point before countering it.
Example: Although homework can provide several benefits, it may also place unnecessary pressure on young children who already attend school for long hours.

3. Pattern: "This is particularly true/beneficial for..., as..." — *Function:* narrow a claim to a specific group.
Example: This is particularly beneficial for students with part-time jobs, as recorded lectures allow them to study at hours that suit their schedules.

4. Pattern: "Unless appropriate measures are introduced, ..." — *Function:* warn of a consequence, implying a solution is needed.
Example: Unless appropriate measures are introduced, students from low-income households risk falling further behind in a system that depends heavily on private tutoring.

5. Pattern: "X, which can result in Y." — *Function:* link cause and effect with a relative clause.
Example: Large class sizes reduce the amount of individual attention each student receives, which can result in weaker academic performance among quieter learners.

6. Pattern: "By doing X, institutions/governments can..." — *Function:* describe a solution with a participle structure.
Example: By investing in teacher training, governments can significantly improve the quality of instruction in under-resourced schools.

7. Pattern: "Consequently, ..." — *Function:* signal a logical result at the end of an argument.
Example: Consequently, students who receive continuous feedback throughout the

term tend to develop stronger writing skills than those assessed only through a final exam.

8. Pattern: "It is often argued that..., although..." — *Function:* present a common view before gently challenging it.
Example: It is often argued that vocational training is less valuable than a university degree, although many skilled trades now offer comparable, and sometimes higher, long-term earnings.

Part G — Paraphrasing Practice

1. Original

> *Some people think that children should start learning a foreign language at primary school rather than secondary school.*

Key concepts: children; foreign language; primary school; secondary school; early start.
Possible transformations: "some people" → "it is widely believed"; "start learning" → "begin acquiring".
Model paraphrase: It is widely believed that foreign-language education should begin during primary school rather than being delayed until secondary level.
Why it works: The reporting structure and key verbs changed while the comparison between primary and secondary school was preserved.

2. Original

> *Examinations are the best way of assessing a student's ability.*

Key concepts: examinations; assessment; student ability.
Possible transformations: change word form (examinations → testing); reconstruct with "the most effective means of".
Model paraphrase: Formal testing is often regarded as the most effective means of evaluating what students have learned.
Why it works: "Best way" became "most effective means", and the claim was reworded without changing its meaning.

3. Original

> *Many students today prefer practical skills to academic subjects.*

Key concepts: students; preference; practical skills; academic subjects.
Possible transformations: shift focus from students to the skills; add a time nuance ("increasingly").
Model paraphrase: Practical skills are increasingly favoured by students over purely academic subjects.
Why it works: The sentence focus moved from the students doing the preferring to the skills being preferred (Method D).

4. Original

> *Parents, rather than teachers, have the greatest influence on a child's success in school.*

Key concepts: parents; teachers; influence; academic success.
Possible transformations: make "parental involvement" the new grammatical subject.
Model paraphrase: A child's academic achievement is shaped more significantly by parental involvement than by the efforts of classroom teachers.
Why it works: The comparison is preserved but restructured, avoiding a mechanical word-for-word swap.

5. Original

> *Homework gives students the chance to practise what they have learned in class.*

Key concepts: homework; practice; classroom learning; reinforcement.
Possible transformations: practise → consolidate; "what they have learned" → "the material covered".
Model paraphrase: Completing homework allows learners to consolidate the material covered during lessons.
Why it works: A natural synonym shift was used instead of a literal word substitution.

Part H — Idea-Development Exercises

Instructions: Try developing each basic idea yourself using **WHY → HOW → RESULT → EXAMPLE** before reading the model answers that follow.

1. Technology makes learning more engaging.
2. University education is too expensive for many families.
3. Vocational training prepares students better for employment than purely academic study.

Model Answers

1. Technology makes learning more engaging.

Why? Traditional lessons can feel repetitive, and many students lose concentration during long verbal explanations.

How? Interactive tools such as videos, educational games, and simulations let students see and experience concepts rather than simply hear about them.

Result? Students remain focused for longer periods and often retain information more effectively.

Example? A geography teacher who uses an interactive map to show plate tectonics in motion is likely to hold students' attention far better than a textbook diagram alone.

2. University education is too expensive for many families.

Why? Tuition fees, accommodation, and living costs have risen faster than average household income in many countries.

How? Families are often forced to take out large loans or ask students to work part-time alongside their studies.

Result? Some capable students either avoid university altogether or graduate with significant debt affecting their early financial independence.

Example? Where tuition fees exceed a year's average salary, many talented students from low-income backgrounds choose cheaper vocational routes instead, regardless of academic potential.

3. Vocational training prepares students better for employment than purely academic study.

Why? Employers in many industries value practical competence as much as, or more than, theoretical knowledge.

How? Vocational programs combine classroom instruction with workplace placements, apprenticeships, or hands-on technical training.

Result? Graduates enter the workforce already familiar with real working conditions, reducing the on-the-job training employers must provide.

Example? A student who completes an electrical apprenticeship typically requires far less additional training than a graduate with a general academic degree seeking the same trade position.

Part I — IELTS Question Bank

1. Some people believe that university education should be free for all students, while others think students should pay for their own education. Discuss both views and give your own opinion. *(Discuss Both Views)*
2. Many students choose to study online rather than attend traditional classroom-based courses. Do the advantages of this trend outweigh the disadvantages? *(Advantages Outweigh Disadvantages)*
3. Continuous assessment, rather than final examinations, should be used to evaluate students' performance. To what extent do you agree or disagree? *(Opinion / Agree–Disagree)*
4. In some countries, teachers have more influence on children's development than parents. What are the causes of this, and what solutions can you suggest? *(Problem/Cause + Solution)*
5. Some people think schools should focus on teaching practical skills, while others believe academic subjects are more important. Discuss both views and give your opinion. *(Discuss Both Views)*
6. Vocational training is becoming increasingly popular as an alternative to university education. Why is this happening, and is it a positive development? *(Two-Part / Direct Question)*
7. Homework has little educational value and should be reduced or abolished in primary schools. To what extent do you agree or disagree? *(Opinion / Agree–Disagree)*
8. What are the advantages and disadvantages of using technology, such as tablets and computers, in primary school classrooms? *(Advantages–Disadvantages)*
9. Some people argue that university education should focus only on preparing students for employment, while others believe it should also develop broader knowledge and character. Discuss both views and give your opinion. *(Discuss Both Views)*
10. In many countries, children's development is increasingly shaped by screens rather than outdoor play or family interaction. What are the causes of this, and

what measures could address it? *(Problem/Cause + Solution)*

Next step: Review this chapter, then the next practice sheet will apply the same template (Parts A–I) to a second Education sub-topic — most likely **Free Education** or **Exams vs Continuous Assessment** — before moving on to Chapter 2 (Technology & Internet).